

10.3 Cataloguing Tools

Okay. So now you know what to do and how to do it, but where the heck do you do it?! There are several readily (and more importantly, freely) available softwares that help one organise one's music collection. Here's a look at some of the most popular ones.

10.3.1 iTunes

iTunes is the proprietary media player of Apple Computers, and is fast gaining ground as the most popular media application in the world. Given the dominance of the iPod in the portable audio device market, it's not surprising that Apple also have one of the best media players. Incidentally, iTunes also acts as the sync between the iPod and your computer.

10.3.1.1 You've Come A Long Way Baby

Macintosh software distributed a popular MP3 application called SoundJam MP which was used by most Mac users. When Apple bought the rights to SoundJam, it changed the name of the software to iTunes, made a few modifications and released it in January, 2001. Currently, Apple has released version 6.04 of the software which has several improvements over its predecessors including access to iTunes store in the user interface itself.

10.3.1.2 Compatibility

Originally, iTunes was designed only for the Mac OS but these days it is compatible with computers running Windows XP, 2000 and Server 2003. It is not supported on non-NT versions of Windows like 98 and Me. Linux users can run iTunes using the Crossover Office platform. iTunes can be downloaded for free from www.apple.com/itunes

10.3.1.3 Features, Features Everywhere

With more explorable features than a French supermodel, iTunes is as user-friendly as it can get. The latest release of the software is brimming with cool tools that let you organise, access and edit your media files with German efficiency, Japanese speed and American spunk.